



By **Claude Gunasekera**
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Cinnamon Grand Colombo Celebrates "20 Years of Grand Excellence" in a Gala Event, end November, 2025.

In a landmark moment for Sri Lankan hospitality, the iconic Cinnamon Grand Colombo is proudly marking two decades of timeless elegance, exceptional service, and cherished memories. It has been a cornerstone of Colombo's social and business landscape. It has not only welcomed global dignitaries and celebrities but has also become an integral part of countless personal milestones for its guests.

A Legacy of Redefining Luxury

From its inception, Cinnamon Grand Colombo aimed to set new benchmarks in the city's hospitality scene. The hotel's distinctive architecture, including its soaring atrium lobby – a groundbreaking feature in the region at the time – has long awed visitors. Over the past 20 years, it has consistently delivered a blend of authentic Sri Lankan warmth and world-class luxury, earning a reputation for excellence in dining, events, and accommodation. As Cinnamon Grand Colombo looks to the future, it remains committed to setting the benchmark for luxury hospitality in the region, continuing its legacy of creating unforgettable moments and inspiring memories for many years to come.

The grand anniversary gala on November 26th is expected to be a night of celebration and reflection. Key management figures, including Chief Operating Executive (COO) Kamal Munasinghe, are expected to address attendees. Loyal business partners, distinguished guests, and media representatives are expected to attend the grand celebration.

The hotel now known as Cinnamon Grand Colombo was originally established as the Hotel Lanka Oberoi, opening its doors in 1975. It was rebranded after a series of ownership and management changes in the early 2000s. Hotel Lanka Oberoi officially commenced operations in 1975. It was the very first international venture for Oberoi Hotels outside of India. The hotel was an architectural marvel for its time, featuring a groundbreaking soaring atrium lobby designed by the renowned American architectural firm Skidmore, Owings & Merrill (SOM). In 2003 the management changed and rebranded as Colombo Plaza Hotel.

Cinnamon
**GRAND
COLOMBO**



In the same year, John Keells Holdings (JKH) acquired a controlling stake in the owning company, Asian Hotels Ltd. and in 2005 relaunched as Cinnamon Grand Colombo. John Keells Holdings, as part of a larger strategy to re-position its leisure properties, rebranded the hotel as Cinnamon Grand in 2005. The hotel served as the flagship property for the newly launched "Cinnamon Hotels & Resorts" brand.